

Emotion Snapshot Audit Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	emotion-snapshot-audit

Big idea: Emotion is not merely noise in knowing; it can focus, filter, and frame evidence.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Scene: a student sees two friends whispering and laughing near the classroom door. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Emotion Snapshot Audit Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Emotion is not merely noise in knowing; it can focus, filter, and frame evidence.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Emotion Snapshot Audit Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	How does emotion shape what knowers notice?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Scene: a student sees two friends whispering and laughing near the classroom door.
- Emotion frames: anxious, excited, suspicious, calm, embarrassed, proud.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Activity Steps

1. Show students the same ambiguous stimulus without discussion.
2. Assign groups different emotion frame cards.
3. Groups list what details they notice, what they infer, and what they ignore.
4. Compare interpretations across emotion frames.
5. Debrief emotion as evidence, filter, and interpretive context.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: How does emotion shape what knowers notice?
- Can emotion improve knowledge by making some evidence salient?
- When does emotional interpretation become distortion?

Knowledge Questions

- How does emotion shape what knowers notice?
- Can emotion be a source of insight as well as bias?
- When should emotional evidence be checked by other methods?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with students make a judgement under an emotion prompt, then re-evaluate after a pause. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...